However, my search for a framework was not helped by the fact that I lacked formal training in this area of humanities. It was at this juncture that in April 2020, I was approached to speak on the Indian Constitution at a webinar meant for Indian Americans. After the webinar, Dr. Indu Viswanathan, a Hindu-American scholar and educator whose brainchild the session was, happened to remark that my work on reconciling the Constitution with Indic civilisational perspectives fell within the purview of ‘decoloniality’. To put it in her words, she called it ‘decoloniality in action’, which several other similarly placed societies had witnessed. She urged me to look into decoloniality in order to understand its applicability to the Indic position and was kind enough to share some of the literature on the subject. As a result, I started reading the works of scholars, such as Aníbal Quijano, Walter D. Mignolo, Sylvia Wynter, Ramón Grosfoguel, Catherine E. Walsh and Nelson Maldonado-Torres, among others. Dr. Viswanathan also put me in touch with another brilliant scholar of decoloniality, Ms Sumita Ambasta, who introduced me to literature that shed light on colonial language policies, and the writings of Arturo Escobar whose perspectives on the relationship between coloniality and ‘development’ is a must-read for development professionals in Bharat.

In my exploration of the subject, I learnt that ‘coloniality’, as first conceptualised by Latin-American scholar Aníbal Quijano, informed the European coloniser’s use of power and was the very basis and justification for exploitation of the world. Coloniality was the fount of European colonialism, which in turn was rooted in the coloniser’s religious beliefs that gave birth to his sense of racial superiority that placed the Christian White European coloniser at the top of the world order. It was this sense of superiority, which the European coloniser treated as both a divinely ordained right and scientific fact, that led to the creation of racial hierarchies the world over. Coloniality reshaped the very concept of history and time through the creation of constructs as ‘modernity’ and ‘rationality’, terms which are loosely used in contemporary everyday conversations without knowledge of their colonial origins. This colonial matrix of power, to which both modernity and rationality were integral, had the effect of negating the cultural experience and subjectivities of colonised societies, so much so that according to the coloniser, their histories began only upon his advent.